



Zoo Explorers

Meet the Blue Whale!

Endangered

Facts • Colour • Activities

Blue Whale Fact File

Scientific name:	Balaenoptera musculus
Status:	Endangered
Where they live:	All major oceans — Atlantic, Pacific, Indian, Southern
Habitat:	All the world's oceans — migrates between polar feeding areas and warm tropical breeding grounds
Diet:	Filter feeder — krill (tiny shrimp-like creatures); eats up to 4 tonnes per day
Weight:	Up to 150–170 tonnes
Lifespan:	80–90 years
Population:	Estimated 10,000–25,000 worldwide (recovering after near-extinction)

Amazing Facts

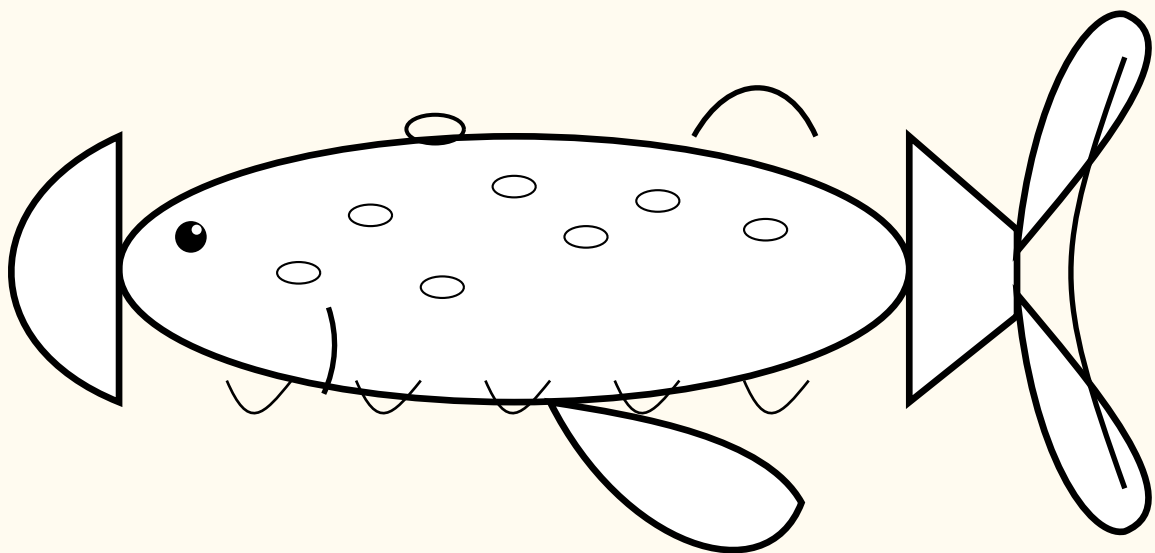
- The blue whale is the largest animal ever known to have lived — bigger than any dinosaur.
- Its heart is the size of a small car and beats just 5–6 times per minute.
- A blue whale's call can be heard up to 1,600 km away — the loudest sound made by any animal.
- Blue whale calves gain around 91 kg (200 lbs) every single day during their first year.
- They can dive to over 500 metres and hold their breath for up to 90 minutes.
- Over 360,000 blue whales were killed by whalers in the 20th century — nearly wiping them out.

Threats

#	Threat	Impact
1	Ship strikes	CRITICAL
2	Entanglement in fishing nets	HIGH
3	Ocean noise pollution disrupting communication	HIGH
4	Climate change reducing krill populations	MODERATE

Colour Me! — Blue Whale

Blue whales are blue-grey on top with a mottled lighter pattern. Their underside has a yellowish tinge from tiny organisms.



Activities ⇒

Word Search — find all 8 words!

D	P	Z	K	R	I	L	L	D	F	L	P
M	I	G	R	A	T	I	O	N	E	M	H
L	X	V	M	Y	F	W	K	K	T	C	D
Z	Q	P	D	P	W	U	Z	R	T	E	E
B	U	Z	L	T	H	H	E	X	R	T	K
L	T	T	V	A	A	T	C	E	L	N	M
O	Q	N	K	X	L	O	G	T	L	D	Z
W	L	A	Q	I	E	N	C	A	G	E	D
H	Y	E	F	Z	A	Y	M	E	C	A	E
O	E	Y	Q	D	W	M	T	S	A	R	X
L	W	H	N	K	A	A	O	U	E	N	D
E	Z	E	E	M	I	P	N	V	T	W	H

WHALE	OCEAN	KRILL	ENDANGERED
MIGRATION	MAMMAL	BLOWHOLE	FILTER

Match It Up!

Blue whale		past hunting that nearly wiped them out
Krill		how a whale breathes
Blowhole		long journey between oceans
Migration		largest animal on Earth
Whaling		tiny shrimp the whale eats

Fill in the Blanks!

- The blue whale is the _____ animal ever to have lived on Earth.
- Blue whales eat tiny shrimp-like creatures called _____.
- A blue whale's call can be heard _____ km away.
- Blue whales breathe through a _____ on top of their head.

Answers: largest | krill | 1,600 | blowhole

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